

Multiple Electroconvulsive Therapy (MECT)

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Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

160.25

Manual Section Title

Multiple Electroconvulsive Therapy (MECT)

Version Number

1

Effective Date of this Version

04/01/2003

Implementation Date

04/01/2003

Description Information

Benefit Category

Physicians' Services

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

The clinical effectiveness of the multiple-seizure electroconvulsive therapy has not been verified by scientifically controlled studies. In addition, studies have demonstrated an increased risk of adverse effects with multiple seizures. Accordingly, MECT cannot be considered reasonable and necessary and is not covered by the Medicare program.

Claims Processing Instructions

TN AB-03-003 (Program Memorandum Intermediaries/Carriers) [↗](#)

Transmittal Information

Transmittal Number

166

Coverage Transmittal Link

<https://www.cms.gov/Regulations-and-Guidance/Guidance/Transmittals/Downloads/R166CIM.pdf>

Revision History

01/2003 - Delineated noncoverage policy for this treatment. Effective and implementation dates 04/01/2003. ([TN 166](#)) (CR 2499)

National Coverage Analyses (NCAs)

This NCD has been or is currently being reviewed under the National Coverage Determination process. The following are existing associations with NCAs, from the National Coverage Analyses database.

- [Original Consideration for Multiple-Seizure Electroconvulsive Therapy \(CAG-00134N\)](#)

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
Multiple Electroconvulsive Therapy (MECT)	1	04/01/2003 - N/A	You are here